

**This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.**

Patient Group Direction

for the administration of Qdenga (TAK-003) for the treatment of Dengue Fever Prevention

## Summary of NICE / NICE CKS Guidelines for Dengue Fever Prevention

### Overview

Dengue fever is caused by the dengue virus, of which there are four serotypes (DENV-1, DENV-2, DENV-3, DENV-4). The disease is transmitted by Aedes mosquitoes and is endemic in tropical and subtropical regions worldwide, affecting over 400 million people annually.

### Assessment

- **Travel destination risk:** Assess if the patient is travelling to or will reside in dengue-endemic areas.
- **Previous dengue infection:** Obtain history of previous dengue infection, if known.
- **Duration of stay:** Evaluate the intended duration and timing of travel.
- **Immunisation status:** Confirm current vaccinations and previous dengue serology if available.

### Management

- **Vaccination schedule:** Two doses of Qdenga administered 3 months apart via subcutaneous injection.
- **Mosquito bite prevention:** Advise on insect repellents, protective clothing, and accommodation with air conditioning and/or screens.
- **Timing:** First dose should be administered at least 3 months prior to travel when possible.

### Red Flags and Contraindications

- **Immunocompromised individuals:** Live attenuated vaccine is contraindicated in those with severe immunocompromise.
- **Pregnancy and breastfeeding:** Vaccine is not recommended during pregnancy or breastfeeding.
- **Severe acute illness:** Defer vaccination if the patient has acute febrile illness or other significant illness.
- **Concurrent live vaccines:** If other live vaccines are required, Qdenga should be given simultaneously or separated by at least 4 weeks.

### Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

**Qdenga (TAK-003)**

for the treatment of

**Dengue Fever Prevention**

## Healthcare professionals covered and training

|                                              | Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
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| <b>Qualifications and Registration</b>       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC</li> <li>• Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Training and assessment</b>               | <p>Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines</li> <li>• All users must previously have used PGDs to supply medication</li> <li>• Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer</li> <li>• All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service</li> </ul> |
| <b>Further training and responsibilities</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal</li> <li>• All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products</li> <li>• All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

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| <b>PGD Indication</b>     | Immunisation against dengue fever in adults aged 18 years and over travelling to or residing in dengue-endemic areas.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Inclusion criteria</b> | <p>Age 18 years or over</p> <p>Planning travel to or residence in dengue-endemic area(s)</p> <p>Willing to receive two doses, 3 months apart</p> <p>Able to provide informed consent</p> <p>Not pregnant and not breastfeeding</p> <p>Not severely immunocompromised</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Exclusion criteria</b> | <p>Age under 18 years</p> <p>Pregnancy or breastfeeding</p> <p>Known hypersensitivity to any component of the vaccine</p> <p>Severe immunocompromise (including HIV with CD4 count &lt; 200, active malignancy, prolonged high-dose corticosteroids)</p> <p>Acute fever or significant intercurrent illness</p> <p>Planned administration of another live vaccine within 4 weeks before or after Qdenga</p> <p>History of Guillain-Barré syndrome following prior dengue</p> |

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|                                                             | vaccination                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Cautions</b>                                             | <p>Use with caution in patients with mild to moderate immunosuppression</p> <p>Use with caution in patients on anticoagulant therapy (assess bleeding risk)</p> <p>Patients should avoid pregnancy for at least 4 weeks after each dose</p> <p>Live vaccine - not suitable for severely immunocompromised individuals</p> <p>Consider serological testing in those with previous dengue infection</p> <p>Administration should be deferred in patients with acute febrile illness</p> |
| <b>Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment</b> | <p>Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed.</p> <p>Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

#### *Details of the medicine*

|                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
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| <b>Name, form and strength of medicine</b>         | Qdenga (TAK-003), suspension for injection in pre-filled syringe, 0.5 mL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Legal category</b>                              | POM (Prescription Only Medicine)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Storage</b>                                     | Store in a refrigerator between 2°C and 8°C. Protect from light. Do not freeze. After reconstitution, use within 30 minutes.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Route/method of administration</b>              | Subcutaneous injection, preferably in the deltoid area of the upper arm                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Dose and frequency</b>                          | <p>First dose: 0.5 mL subcutaneously</p> <p>Second dose: 0.5 mL subcutaneously, administered 3 months after the first dose</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Quantity to be administered and/or supplied</b> | 2 doses of 0.5 mL each over a 3-month period                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Maximum or minimum treatment period</b>         | Vaccination series over 3 months (with optional booster after 12 months based on ongoing exposure risk)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Adverse effects</b>                             | <p>Very common (<math>\geq 1/10</math>): Injection site pain, headache, myalgia</p> <p>Common (<math>\geq 1/100</math> to <math>&lt; 1/10</math>): Malaise, fatigue, fever (usually within 7 days of vaccination)</p> <p>Uncommon (<math>\geq 1/1,000</math> to <math>&lt; 1/100</math>): Rash, pruritus, arthralgia</p> <p>Rare: Guillain-Barré syndrome (very rare, temporal relationship to vaccination unclear)</p> <p>Report all suspected adverse effects via the Yellow Card scheme at</p> |

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|  | <a href="https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk">https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk</a> |
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| <b>Yellow card reporting</b> | Report suspected adverse effects via <a href="https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk">https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk</a> and inform the GP as appropriate.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Records to be kept</b>    | <p>Record the following information:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• that valid informed consent was given</li> <li>• name of individual, address, date of birth and GP</li> <li>• name of healthcare practitioner</li> <li>• name and brand of medication</li> <li>• date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied</li> <li>• advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment</li> <li>• details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD</li> </ul> <p>Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made.</p> <p>A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years</li> <li>• Children aged under 18 years - keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)</li> </ul> |

### ***Patient information***

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| <b>Written information to be given to patient or carer</b> | Supply the patient information leaflet (PIL) provided with Qdenga. Ensure the patient understands the vaccine schedule, storage requirements, and what to expect after vaccination.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer</b>    | <p>Attend for second dose appointment in 3 months</p> <p>Report any unusual or severe symptoms to your healthcare provider or via the Yellow Card scheme</p> <p>Seek medical advice if fever develops or persists beyond 7 days after vaccination</p> <p>Avoid pregnancy for at least 4 weeks after each dose if of childbearing potential</p> <p>Continue mosquito bite prevention measures (insect repellent, protective clothing) even after vaccination</p> <p>Seek immediate medical attention if you develop rash, difficulty breathing, or signs of anaphylaxis after vaccination</p> <p>If you experience signs of dengue fever (fever, headache, rash, joint pain) whilst travelling, seek medical attention promptly</p> <p>Keep a record of your vaccination dates and bring documentation</p> |

|  |                 |
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|  | when travelling |
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## Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017  
<https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mg2>
- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017  
<https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources>
- NICE CKS Guidance: Dengue Fever Immunisation and Prevention
- British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines

## Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|---------------------|-----------|
| Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates |             |                     |           |
|                                                                                   |             |                     |           |
| Name of healthcare professional                                                   | Job title   | Registration number | Signature |
|                                                                                   |             |                     |           |
|                                                                                   |             |                     |           |
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| Valid from date                                                                   | Expiry date |                     |           |
| 1/11/25                                                                           | 31/7/27     |                     |           |

## PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or medicine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

| Name of superintendent / clinical lead | Job title & name of organisation | Signature | Date |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------|------|
|                                        |                                  |           |      |
| Name of professional group signatory   | Job title & name of organisation | Signature | Date |
|                                        |                                  |           |      |

**Signed on behalf of Get Real Health**

| Name             | Qualification                  | Signature                                                                            | Date    |
|------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Nitin Shori      | Medical Doctor<br>GMC: 6047293 |    | 2/11/25 |
| Chris Pilkington | Pharmacist<br>GPhC: 2046322    |  | 2/11/25 |

**Change history**

| Version number | Change details                 | Date              |
|----------------|--------------------------------|-------------------|
| 001            | Development & issue of new PGD | 1st November 2025 |
|                |                                |                   |
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